



ADVISORY NOTE

2017-3

Reference Building Verification Method V2.6.2.2

Application

<i>NCC Volume:</i>	<i>Two</i>
<i>Section/Part:</i>	<i>Section 2; Part 2.6</i>
<i>Date first issued:</i>	<i>September 2017</i>
<i>Date revised:</i>	<i>October 2017</i>

Copyright and licence notice

© 2017 Commonwealth of Australia and States and Territories of Australia
Ownership of intellectual property rights

Unless otherwise noted, copyright (and any other intellectual property rights, if any) in this publication is jointly owned by the Commonwealth, States and Territories of Australia.

**Creative Commons
licence Attribution
CC BY-NC-ND 4.0**



All material in this publication is licensed under a Creative Commons Attribution-NonCommercial-NoDerivatives 4.0 International Licence, save for logos. Attribution-NonCommercial-NoDerivatives 4.0 International Licence is a standard form licence agreement that does not permit any commercial use or derivatives of the original work. Under this licence: you may only distribute a verbatim copy of the work and must not adapt or change the work in any way. You must give appropriate credit and provide a link to the licence. You may do so in any reasonable manner, but not in any way that suggests the Commonwealth of Australia, States and Territories of Australia or Australian Building Codes Board endorses you or your use. You may not use the material for commercial purposes. If you remix, transform, or build upon the material for your own use, you may not distribute the modified material.

The full licence terms are available from <http://creativecommons.org/licenses/by-nc-nd/4.0/legalcode>.

Content contained herein should be attributed as:

The Reference Building Verification Method V2.6.2.2 Advisory Note[©] as released by the Australian Building Codes Board on behalf of the Commonwealth of Australia and States and Territories of Australia

Disclaimer

This Advisory Note is intended to be used as guidance material to assist in interpreting the National Construction Code (NCC). It is in no way a substitute for the NCC and related State and Territory legislation and does not in any way constitute the provision of professional advice. Users must carefully evaluate the accuracy, currency, completeness and relevance of the material within the Advisory Note for their own purposes.

The General Manager of the Australian Buildings Code Board, as agent for the Commonwealth of Australia and States and Territories of Australia, does not accept any liability howsoever arising from or connected to the use or reliance on any information in this publication except in accordance with this Important Notice and Disclaimer.

Published by: Australian Building Codes Board
GPO Box 2013
CANBERRA ACT 2601
Phone: 1300 134 631
Email: ncc@abcb.gov.au
www.abcb.gov.au

First published: September 2017
Print version: 1.1
Release date: October 2017



Introduction

The purpose of this Advisory Note is to clarify which types of calculation methods, or energy analysis software, can be used under the National Construction Code (NCC) Volume Two reference building Verification Method for houses, V2.6.2.2.

Background

The Australian Building Codes Board (ABCB) has been advised that NatHERS¹ software is, in some cases, being incorrectly used in conjunction with V2.6.2.2.

The specific input requirements in V2.6.2.2 are not always being complied with when practitioners use NatHERS software in conjunction with the Verification Method. In particular, this applies to the temperature settings and the unique features of the proposed house (e.g. zoning and overshadowing).

Content

There are four basic options for complying with the NCC's energy efficiency provisions for housing:

1. use of NatHERS accredited software to achieve the specified star rating (as per 3.12.0 (a)(i));
2. compliance with the prescriptive Deemed-to-Satisfy elemental provisions (as per 3.12.0 (a)(ii));
3. use of the reference building Verification Method (V2.6.2.2); and
4. development of a Performance Solution other than V2.6.2.2.

Unlike the star rating approach (option 1 above), which requires the use of NatHERS software, V2.6.2.2 does not require the use of a particular calculation method. Rather, any calculation method can be used provided it complies with the requirements listed in subclause V2.6.2.2(c).

The Commonwealth Department of the Environment and Energy, in its capacity as the NatHERS Administrator, has advised that NatHERS accredited software only satisfies the temperature settings in V2.6.2.2(c) in a limited number of circumstances. The NatHERS Administrator has published information about this matter on its [website](#).

¹ Nationwide House Energy Rating Scheme



Practitioners are advised to ensure all of the requirements specified in V2.6.2.2 are being correctly applied, in particular the temperature settings and the unique features of the proposed house (e.g. zoning and overshadowing). The incorrect application of V2.6.2.2 can result in houses delivering a level of energy efficiency substantially below that required by the NCC.

The above requirements also need to be read in conjunction with the building legislation of the relevant State or Territory.

Further information

A full description of V2.6.2.2 and guidance on how it should be applied is included in the ABCB handbook: *NCC Volume Two Energy Efficiency Provisions 2016*. The handbook is available on the [ABCB website](#).